



RESIT REFLECTION

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Reflection

During semester 2 of my second year, I missed a number of theory classes across both periods, and I would like to honestly reflect on why that happened, what effect it had, and what I should have done, and should do, differently.

In period three, I missed a theory class because I had the flu and genuinely felt too sick to attend. To be sick is understandable, but what is not understandable is the fact that my communication with the lecturer was handled poorly. As far as I can remember, I did not notify the lecturer that I would not be attending the theory class or explain the reason for my absence.

Also in period three, I missed another theory class due to a situation my team had with the client. He had threatened to cancel our project, and I felt that I needed to speak to my project lecturers as soon as possible, which resulted in me missing the theory class. However, I again failed to inform my lecturer, which really shows a consistent pattern in my lack of communication.

In period four, the absences happened more often and were related to my work schedule. Throughout the entire year, Wednesdays were normally days without classes, so I arranged my work schedule around that by working a 22:00–02:00 shift on Tuesdays, as that is a requirement of my job. I also need this job as it helps pay for my basic needs and personal expenses. However, due to the large number of public holidays, the schedule changed and classes were moved to Wednesdays. Unfortunately, having a class at 09:15 after finishing work at 02:00 meant I would only get around four to five hours of sleep. Because of this, I chose not to attend classes that started that early, as I felt I would be too tired to concentrate and get much value from them. Again, I did not handle the communication well with the lecturer, as I did not notify them of my absence beforehand, which I should have done.

I do not want this to sound like an excuse, but it does explain why I missed those theory classes. However, it does not change the fact that I should have either attended or communicated better with the lecturer about not attending.

The final theory class I missed happened for a completely different reason. I had some free time between lessons, so I decided to hand in my resignation at work, as I will be leaving Emmen soon and wanted to avoid having to worry about work during any potential move. Unfortunately, the conversation took much longer than expected, and I ended up missing the class. Because of the unexpected delay, I was unable to communicate this beforehand, but I still think I should have informed my lecturer afterwards.

As a result of these absences, I was unaware of certain deadlines and missed out on useful information, such as tips for improving my CV, internship preparation, and portfolio requirements. I also lost opportunities to ask questions during those sessions. Another consequence was that I had to rely on my teammates to update me on what I had missed, which is unfair because it is not their responsibility to keep me informed about my studies.

When I look back at all of these situations, there was one consistent issue besides the absences themselves: a lack of communication. A simple email would have made a big difference and would have been much more professional. Going forward, if I cannot attend something, I need to communicate this to the relevant people and make sure they are aware of the situation. I should also follow up with the lecturer afterwards so that I can stay on top of my studies and not miss important information. In addition, I think I should make more effort to adjust my work schedule when I have classes the next morning, because while my job supports my present situation, my studies are what will support my future.